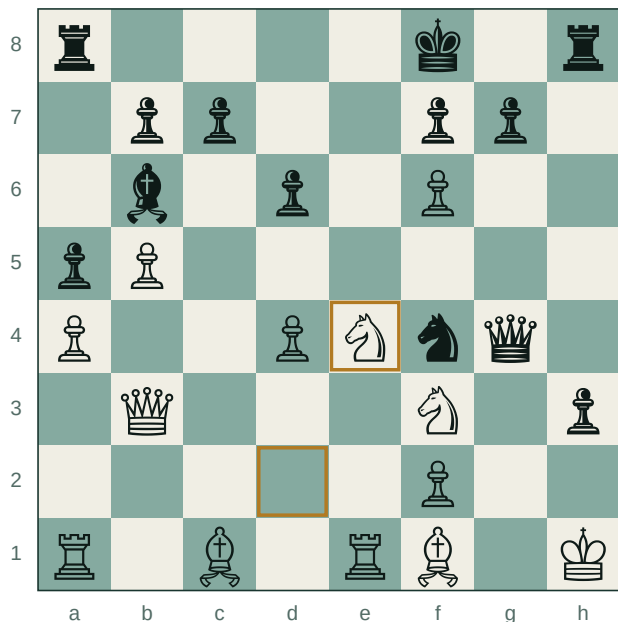


Double checks: Black, move 21

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Ne4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Qg2+ 22. Bxg2 hxg2+ 23. Kg1 Rh1#

21...Qg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g2 it attacks king on h1, knight on f3 and bishop on f1.
Recorded reply: **22.Bxg2**.

22...hxg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on h8 attacks the king on h1.
Recorded reply: **23.Kg1**.

23...Rh1# Mate: rook on h1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: queen on b3 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.